FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOGUE

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

HAIR; HORSE, CURLED

This specification was approved for promulgation by the Federal Specifications Board on October 14, 1930, for use of the departments and independent establishments of the Government in the purchase of this commodity and shall become mandatory for all departments and independent establishments of the Government not later than April 1, 1931. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

PREAMBLE.

The specifications listed below conform in technical detail with this specification and may be used in lieu thereof.

Navy Department No. 27H1a (See Par. H–1a.)

A. APPLICABLE FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS.

A–1. There are no other Federal specifications applicable to this specification.

A–2. Any special requirements of the Government are noted in section H.

B. TYPES.

B–1. Curled horse hair shall be of the following types:

Type A. Horse-mane hair.

Type B. Horse-tail hair.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP, ETC.

C–1. See section D.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D–1. Each type of horsehair shall be well curled and carded (or picker picked) and shall consist of 100 per cent curled hair. The hair shall be resilient new stock.

D–2. The hair shall be clipped, of natural color and free from dye. Not less than two-thirds shall be natural black in color.

D–3. There shall not be present vegetable fibers, fetlock hair, haircloth clippings, combings, reworked hair, or hair from other animals.

D–4. The hair shall be thoroughly washed and all epidermis removed before spinning. There shall be no objectionable animal odor.

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D-5. To insure proper set of curl and complete sterilization, the horsehair, in the form of ropes weighing not more than 5 pounds per 70 feet of length, shall be actively boiled in water for not less than one hour, in such a manner as to insure uniform distribution of temperature. It shall be subsequently stored for not less than 15 days before carding in such a manner as to insure uniform drying.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

E-1. *Mane hair.*—Curled and carded mane hair shall contain by weight less than 17 per cent of short hair 2 inches in length and under and a total of not more than 67 per cent less than 5 inches in length, the remainder to be over 5 inches long.

E-2. *Tail hair.*—Curled and carded tail hair shall contain by weight less than 10 per cent of short hair 2 inches in length and under and a total of not more than 60 per cent less than 5 inches in length, the remainder to be over 5 inches long.

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TESTS.

F-1. Hair offered for delivery shall be divided at the place of manufacture into lots of 500 pounds and a sample of approximately 1 pound taken from each lot or fraction thereof. In a lot for shipment of over 5,000 pounds a sample shall be taken from each one-tenth of the shipment. The samples selected for examination shall be forwarded to the points designated in the proposal or in section H.

F-2. To determine the percentage length of the hair the samples shall be carefully opened out and portions taken from each to make up two samples weighing approximately 5 grams each. The hairs comprising these samples shall be picked out individually and measured along a ruler. Those 2 inches long and under shall be placed in a beaker marked "2 inches and under," the longer hairs placed in their respective beakers marked "2 inches to 5 inches" and "over 5 inches." Upon completion of this picking the contents of each beaker shall be weighed and the percentage of each length calculated against the total weight of the sample. The average of the two samples shall be considered to represent the length of the delivery.

F-3. Tail hair may be distinguished from mane hair by measuring the average diameter of selected samples of tail hair, which shall not be less than 0.0055 inches.

F-4. To determine whether dyed hair is present, gently boil a 5-gram sample of the hair in 250 c. c. of a 20 per cent (by volume) solution of hydrochloric acid in a 400-c. c. beaker. If dyed hair is present a pink coloration will appear in a few minutes, the density of the coloration depending upon the amount of dyed hair present. A 25-gram sample of hair should also be boiled in a 2 per cent solution of sodium carbonate or a 3 per cent solution of ammonium hydroxide for one-half hour. If dyed hair is present, the solution will be darker than if only natural hair were present. When the presence of dyed hair is detected by these methods, some of the hairs shall be cross sectioned by means of a freezing microtome and examined microscopically to prove conclusively that the hair is dyed.

F-5. The test to determine whether hair other than horsehair is present shall be made microscopically.

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F–6. At the time of weighing shipments at the place of delivery, samples shall be selected from the interior of the bales, as described in paragraph F–1, and the combined weight of the samples or of a suitable portion of the samples taken. The combined samples shall then be washed by stirring in a 1 per cent solution of neutral soap in water at a temperature of about 100° F.; after this wash the samples shall be rinsed by stirring in water at a temperature of about 100° F., changing the water as necessary until it is not clouded or discolored after stirring. The sample shall then be brought to a constant dry weight at a temperature of 212° F. and shall then be weighed. The difference between the initial and final weights of the combined sample shall form the basis upon which the weight of the shipment, for purposes of payment, shall be calculated. (See par. I–1a.)

G. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING.

G–1. *Packing.*

G–1a. Horse-mane hair and horse-tail hair shall be packed separately, unless otherwise specified.

G–1b. Unless otherwise specified, horsehair shall be packed in cloth sacks containing approximately 50 pounds. If specified to be delivered in 200-pound bales, the hair shall not be compressed to a density exceeding 6½ pounds per cubic foot.

G–2. *Marking.*—Shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material, the grade, and the net weight contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the manufacturer, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. The following departmental specifications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall respectively form a part of this specification:

H–1a. Navy Department: General Specifications for Inspection of Material, copies of which may be obtained, without cost, upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

H–2. *Requirements.*

H–2a. *Navy Department purchases.*—The samples selected by the inspector of naval material, as covered by paragraph F–1, shall be forwarded to the Commandant, Navy Yard, Philadelphia, Pa.

I. NOTES.

I–1. Payment will be made on the basis of net weight delivered, unless the correction for dirt and moisture, determined as described in paragraph F–6, exceeds 10 per cent of the delivered weight, in which case twice the excess percentage shall be deducted from the weight of the shipment for purposes of payment.

I–2. Horse-mane hair and horse-tail hair should be purchased separately.

I–3. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that

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normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I–4. In order that the contractor may meet the requirements of paragraph D–5 as to storing and carding and that there may be sufficient time for inspection, contracts for horsehair should not call for delivery before 30 days from date of contract or order, and purchasing officers should endeavor to anticipate their needs as far in advance as practicable and submit requests and requisitions accordingly.

I–5. This specification governs all United States Government purchases of this commodity. Users are requested to retain this specification in permanent file until a revision is issued.

I–6. Interested parties are advised that an alphabetical index of Federal specifications may be obtained, as noted in paragraph next below, at a cost of 5 cents.

I–7. Copies of this specification may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Price, 5 cents.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility or any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded, by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention thay may in any way be related thereto.

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